

University Parallel Cohort A

Academic Program Review Cohort A- University Parallel Cycle 2

University Parallel AA & AS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
"Be a great program"	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	

Evidence:

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Volunteer State Community College's University Parallel program offers Associates of Arts and Associate of Science degrees in sixty-seven areas of emphasis. The programs span five academic divisions: Business, Humanities, Math and Science, Social Science and Education, and Health Sciences. The mission of the University Parallel Program aligns with the mission of Volunteer State Community College.

All courses offered by the college correspond with the mandated student learning outcomes for each general education course by the Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR). The courses taught at Volunteer State Community College are offered through four different delivery methods: traditional face-to-face, online, hybrid, and TNeCampus. The faculty of Volunteer State Community College have developed programs designed to meet the educational needs of our service area. Consistency of instruction and preparation of appropriate course materials that meet the students' needs is a challenge, however, faculty implement several learning initiatives to address these challenges. For example, increase direct assessments of University Parallel student learning outcomes, the development of a vigorous Quality Assurance Process for online learning, and the development of the Teaching & Learning Center. Additionally, the academic freedom allowed to each faculty member illustrates the commitment of establishing attainable course outcomes and allows for the implementation of best practices throughout each program's curriculum.

The curriculum of each University Parallel program promotes the mission of the college by providing innovative educational programs in the context of preparing students for successful careers and community service.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan is attached as evidence. Assessed A.S. and A.A. areas of emphasis assessment plans are also attached as evidence. Assessment plans detail the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcome for the A.A. & A.S. are evaluated in a variety of subjects annually. Each division identified faculty members who created standardized rubrics and faculty provided input regarding the creation of those rubrics. Additionally, faculty within each division have chosen an assignment or assessment to evaluate the learning outcomes. Faculty have also identified achievement targets as either "met" or "not met", respective to their content area. Assessments take place once an academic year, but each division has the liberty to choose which semester the outcomes are evaluated.

Evidence:

- ART1035 General Education SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144759
- BIOL 1010 Student Learning Outcome Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145036
- CHEM1030 General Education Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145251
- ECON2100 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144442
- ECON2200 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144504
- GEOL1060 Assessment Rubric- Lab Activity Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145115
- MATH 1530 Student Learning Outcomes Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144954
- MUS1030 General Education SLO Rubric Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144832
- SOCI1010 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144548
- University Parallel A.A. & A.S. Assessment Plan

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends.
2. Attach effectiveness documentation of each assessed area of emphasis.
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Attach: Academic Program Review, University Parallel Area of Emphasis Assessment Reviews

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)	
PLO 1			87.54	12.46	83.81	16.19	93.64	6.36
PLO 2			74.59	25.41	64.87	35.13		
PLO 3			67.01	32.99	62.5	37.5		
PLO 4			77.94	22.06	70.37	29.63	96.36	3.64
PLO 5			81.82	18.18	75	25	92.73	7.27
PLO 6			79.10	20.9	94.2	5.8	78	22
Course Learning Outcome 1 HIST.2010.1 Sources Students will explain the difference between primary and secondary sources.			83.84	16.16	82.03	17.97		
Course Learning Outcome 2 HIST.2010.2 Causes/consequences Students will analyze the causes and consequences of major historical events in early US history			81.96	18.04	81.36	18.64		
Course Learning Outcome 3 HIST.2010.3 Changes Students will demonstrate an understanding of the various social, economic, and political events and changes of the early US period			84.05	15.95	23.82	17.86		

PLO 1: Students will use problem solving as an application of critical thought.

PLO 2: Students will understand and apply knowledge of the foundations and practice in the scientific method of inquiry.

PLO 3: Students will understand and apply knowledge to the foundation and practice in relevant mathematical skills.

PLO 4: Students will demonstrate effective oral communication skills.

PLO 5: Students will demonstrate effective effective written communication skills.

PLO 6: Students will identify and analyze national and global societal challenges.

PLO results dropped in all categories except PLO 7. The most significant drop was in PLO 2, followed by PLO4. The significant decrease in PLO2 is due to students are weaker in science skills coming into college. Additionally, during the transition from Covid to post-Covid, we were seeing students who took more of their science courses online. We know that success went down in the online science courses compared to in-person science courses. Since then we have switched back to modalities that have more in-person components. The significant decrease in PLO4 is most likely a result of the lack of oral communication activity in students due to isolation during the pandemic. The isolation from others increased the level of social anxiety, which decreased the level of effective oral communication skills. Once students were able to return to social activities, too much time had passed in not exercising said skills and at this point, electronic communication was more commonplace than before.

Evidence:

- History Course Learning Outcomes Report
- UPR AA AS PLO_s AY20-23

- UPR AA AS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- UPR AA AS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- UPR AA AS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- University Parallel Learning Outcome - Courses Assessment Chart - UPR

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Analysis of top and low-performing areas of emphasis.
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

1. Assessment of Strengths

The program's biggest strength lies with the faculty at the college. Their ability to adapt and innovate seems to be the driving force behind the increase in graduation rates of students in the University Parallel programs by approximately 500 students from 2020 to 2022, even with the decline of student headcount of approximately 1500 students from Fall 2018 to Fall 2021. There are numerous examples across many departments within the University Parallel program, illustrating the faculty's ability to adapt not only the course modality, but also course content delivery to reach our students' ever-changing needs. Faculty are engaged in HIPs (High Impact Practices), rigorous course review, development and re-development of model courses, annual assessment and review of course learning outcomes, course textbook revisions, and supporting students through the Learning Commons. During the academic audit timeline, the data shows that there are fewer adjunct faculty compared to full-time faculty. This means there are more hours each semester where students have access to faculty during office hours, tutoring time in the Learning Commons, and other unplanned, random interactions with faculty. An increase in student graduation rate in the University Parallel Programs could be attributed to an increase in one-on-one student interactions both inside and outside of the classroom.

3. Areas of Opportunity

In addition to faculty attendance at regional conferences for subject area two-year colleges and similar groups, we find that this is also an area of opportunity. There are several departments within the University Parallel program that would benefit from more consistent interaction with other TBR and out-of-state community colleges and 4-year schools, which would serve both as opportunities to network as well as to gather information about what is being done. This can also lead to continued innovation within our department and program.

Another area of opportunity lies with interdepartmental and cross divisional collaborations and interaction within the program. Many departments have interesting and useful initiatives and other departments may not be aware of these. We find that working on the University Parallel Academic Audit and University Parallel Review makes this clear as we find out about a variety of such initiatives through these processes. This may also be true within each department regarding how classes are taught and different activities, methodologies, and best practices.

By increasing student retention, we would also be increasing graduation rates. Focusing on faculty support of students in the classroom in both content area and study skills and critical thinking abilities may continue to increase graduation rates. Gateway courses, FYEX, and a broader adoption of HIPs, best practices, and innovations that are occurring in some areas.

Another area of opportunity is leadership structure. One of the University Parallel Academic Audit's initiatives from Spring 2023 was to provide a leadership group for the University Parallel program. The goal date for this was Spring 2024. Thus far a leadership group has not been announced. A General Education committee was created and approved in Fall 2022, so the precedent has been set for such a committee for the University Parallel. A leadership organization would go a long way towards accomplishing the area of opportunity listed above.

Evidence:

- University Parallel Academic Audit 2022
- University Parallel- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty	(1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	AY2023-2024 Develop Tutorial Faculty review of the tutorial. Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 Launch video in the model shell	(1) 76% pass rate (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1	To increase student success achievement of all PLOs, faculty have a scheduled time slot during	To provide faculty with resources, strategies, and classroom management techniques to best meet the needs of the	VPAA, Deans, Department Chairs, and Faculty.	Increase of each PLO by 2.5%	Provide a round table discussion time during convocation days. Record minutes to share with	

	convocation to discuss best practices.	student population.			faculty not in attendance.	
2	Increase student learning in PLO #4 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	To provide students with the skills and techniques needed to develop effective oral communication skills.	Deans, department chairs, and faculty	Increase the PLO #4 met outcome rate to 80% which is an increase of 9.63%	Develop the FYEX course by Fall of 2024. Pilot course Spring of 2025. Examine evidence to determine why the rate dropped from 77.94% in 2021 to 70.37% in 2022	Baseline of 77.94 in 2021 70.37% in 2022 of met outcome.
3	Increasing student learning in PLO #3 through the development of course material in Gateway courses.	To provide all students in Gateway math courses additional resources of prerequisite material to ensure they are prepared to learn new and more complex concepts.	Dean Math and Sciences Division, Math Department Chair, and Math Faculty	Increase the PLO #3 met outcome rate to the rate from 2021 (67%)	AY 2023-2024 -Build course material to make Learning Support materials available to all students -Provide material to students by Spring 2025	Baseline of 67.01% (2021) and 52.5% (2022) met the outcome.
4	Increase student learning in PLO #5 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	To provide students with the skills and techniques needed to develop effective written communication skills.	Deans, department chairs, and faculty	Increase the PLO #5 the met outcome rate to the rate from 2021 (81.2%) which is an increase of 6.2%	Develop the FYEX course by Fall of 2024. Pilot course Spring of 2025. Examine evidence to determine why the rate dropped in 2021 from 81.2% to 75% in 2022	Baseline of the met outcome of 81.2% (2021) and 75% (2022).

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee

Faculty will present the General Education Review (GER) to the General Education Committee. The Committee will conduct a review of the UPR and GER. The committee will provide feedback for the completed review and action plan as a supportive step.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Deans should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	To increase student success achievement		During the past academic year, the college experienced a significant leadership	As the new leadership continues to settle in,	Unable to compare because no progress has

	of all PLOs, faculty have a scheduled time slot during convocation to discuss best practices.		transition with the appointment of a new president. While this change brought fresh perspectives and long-term strategic vision, it also required a period of adjustment and realignment of priorities across departments. As the administration focused on assessing current practices and establishing new goals under new leadership, our effort to provide faculty with targeted resources, strategies, and classroom management techniques was temporarily paused or delayed. This transition period limited the availability of time and support needed to fully implement faculty development programs.	we anticipate renewed momentum for faculty support in the upcoming year.	been made in the initiative.
2	Increase student learning in PLO #4 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	The campus-wide FYEX committee created a FYEX model that was shared with each division earlier this semester (2025). Divisions will revise the course, as needed, by the end of April 2025. FYEX courses will go live in Fall 2025.	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #4 79.66% met. This is 0.34% below the goal.
3	Increasing student learning in PLO #3 through the	The Math Gateway courses use a third-party learning platform	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #3 57.88% met. This is a

	development of course material in Gateway courses.	to deliver the majority of course content, including homework assignments, quizzes, and tests. The math department added the Learning Support Math material into these learning platforms in the model courses as optional assignments to ensure that the material is available to all students.			5.38% increase from 2022, but still below the goal.
4	Increase student learning in PLO #5 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	The campus-wide FYEX committee created a FYEX model that was shared with each division earlier this semester (2025). Divisions will revise the course, as needed, by the end of April 2025. FYEX courses will go live in Fall 2025.	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #5 84.05% met. This exceeds the goal of 81.2%.

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1	The tutorial video was launched in the model	None	The assignment success rate for pilot	YES

	by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				